

House File 974

H-1312

1 Amend House File 974 as follows:

2 1. Page 1, before line 1 by inserting:

3 <Section 1. Section 321.18, subsection 7, Code 2025, is
4 amended to read as follows:

5 7. Any school bus in this state used exclusively for
6 the transportation of pupils to and from school or a school
7 function or for the purposes provided in section 285.1,
8 subsection 1, and [section 285.10, subsection 9](#), or used
9 exclusively for the transportation of children enrolled in a
10 federal head start program. Upon application the department
11 shall, without charge, issue a registration certificate and a
12 registration ~~plates~~ plate. The ~~plates~~ plate shall be attached
13 to the ~~front and~~ rear of each bus exempt from registration
14 under [this subsection](#).

15 Sec. _____. Section 321.22, subsection 1, Code 2025, is
16 amended to read as follows:

17 1. An urban transit company or system having a franchise
18 to operate in any city and any regional transit system may
19 make application to the department, upon forms furnished by
20 the department, for a certificate containing a distinguishing
21 number and for one or more ~~pairs of~~ registration plates to be
22 attached to the ~~front and~~ rear of buses owned or operated by
23 the transit company or system.

24 Sec. _____. Section 321.26, subsection 2, Code 2025, is
25 amended to read as follows:

26 2. The county treasurer may adjust the registration renewal
27 or expiration date of vehicles for which the county treasurer
28 is responsible for renewal under [section 321.40](#) when deemed
29 necessary to equalize the number of vehicles registered in
30 each twelve-month period or for the administrative efficiency
31 of the county treasurer's office. The adjustment shall
32 be accomplished by delivery of a written notice to the
33 vehicle owner of the adjustment and allowance of a credit
34 for the remaining months of the unused portion of the annual
35 registration fee, rounded to the nearest whole dollar,

1 which amount shall be deducted from the annual registration
2 fee due at the time of registration. Upon receipt of the
3 notification the owner shall, within thirty days, surrender
4 the registration card and registration ~~plates~~ plate to any
5 county treasurer, except that the registration ~~plates~~ plate
6 shall not be surrendered if a validation stickers sticker or
7 other ~~emblems~~ emblem is used to designate the month and
8 year of expiration of registration. Upon payment of the annual
9 registration fee, less the credit allowed for the remaining
10 months of the unused portion of the annual registration fee,
11 the county treasurer that adjusted the registration renewal or
12 expiration date of the vehicle shall issue a new registration
13 card and registration ~~plates~~ plate, validation ~~stickers~~
14 sticker, or ~~emblems~~ emblem which ~~indicate~~ indicates the month
15 and year of expiration of registration.

16 Sec. _____. Section 321.34, subsections 1 and 2, Code 2025,
17 are amended to read as follows:

18 1. ~~Plates~~ Plate *issued*. The county treasurer upon receiving
19 application, accompanied by proper fee, for registration of a
20 vehicle shall issue to the owner one registration plate for
21 ~~a motorcycle, motorized bicycle, autocycle, truck tractor,~~
22 ~~trailer, or semitrailer and two registration plates for every~~
23 ~~other motor vehicle~~. The registration ~~plates~~ plate, including
24 any special registration ~~plates~~ plate, shall be assigned to the
25 owner of a vehicle. When the owner of a registered vehicle
26 transfers or assigns ownership of the vehicle to another
27 person, the owner shall remove the registration ~~plates~~ plate
28 from the vehicle. The owner shall forward the ~~plates~~ plate to
29 any county treasurer or the owner may have the ~~plates~~ plate
30 assigned to another vehicle within thirty days after transfer,
31 upon payment of the fees required by law. The owner shall
32 immediately affix the registration ~~plates~~ plate retained
33 by the owner to another vehicle owned or acquired by the
34 owner, providing the owner complies with [section 321.46](#). The
35 department shall adopt rules providing for the assignment of a

1 registration ~~plates~~ plate to the transferee of a vehicle for
2 which a credit is allowed under [section 321.46, subsection 6.](#)

3 2. *Validation stickers.*

4 a. In lieu of issuing a new registration plates plate
5 each registration year for a vehicle renewing registration,
6 the department may reassign the registration ~~plates~~ plate
7 previously issued to the vehicle and may adopt and prescribe
8 an annual validation sticker indicating payment of annual
9 registration fees. The department shall issue one validation
10 sticker for each ~~set of~~ registration ~~plates~~ plate. The
11 sticker shall specify the month and year of expiration of the
12 registration ~~plates~~ plate. The sticker shall be displayed
13 ~~only on the rear registration plate, except that the sticker~~
14 ~~shall be displayed on the front registration plate of a truck~~
15 ~~tractor.~~

16 b. The state department of transportation shall adopt rules
17 to provide for the placement of the motor vehicle registration
18 validation sticker.>

19 2. Page 2, by striking lines 23 through 29 and inserting:

20 <Sec. _____. Section 321.37, Code 2025, is amended to read as
21 follows:

22 **321.37 Display of ~~plates~~ plate.**

23 1. ~~Registration plates~~ The registration plate issued for a
24 motor vehicle other than an ~~autocycle, motorcycle, motorized~~
25 ~~bicycle, or a~~ truck tractor shall be attached to the rear of
26 the motor vehicle, ~~one in the front and the other in the rear.~~
27 ~~The registration plate issued for an autocycle, motorcycle,~~
28 ~~or other vehicle required to be registered hereunder shall be~~
29 ~~attached to the rear of the vehicle.~~ The registration plate
30 issued for a truck tractor shall be attached to the front of
31 the truck tractor. The special plate issued to a dealer shall
32 be attached on the rear of the vehicle when operated on the
33 highways of this state.

34 2. ~~Registration plates issued for a motor vehicle which~~
35 ~~is model year 1948 or older, and reconstructed or specially~~

1 ~~constructed vehicles built to resemble a model year 1948~~
2 ~~vehicle or older, other than a truck registered for more than~~
3 ~~five tons, autocycle, motorcycle, or truck tractor, may display~~
4 ~~one registration plate on the rear of the vehicle if the other~~
5 ~~registration plate issued to the vehicle is carried in the~~
6 ~~vehicle at all times when the vehicle is operated on a public~~
7 ~~highway.~~

8 3. 2. ~~It is unlawful for the~~ The owner of a vehicle to
9 shall not place any a frame around or over the registration
10 plate which does not permit full view of all numerals and
11 letters printed on the registration plate, other than the name
12 of the county.

13 Sec. _____. Section 321.115, subsection 1, paragraph c, Code
14 2025, is amended to read as follows:

15 c. The owner of a motor vehicle registered under this
16 subsection may display an authentic Iowa registration plate
17 or set of plates from the model year of the motor vehicle,
18 furnished by the person and approved by the department, in
19 lieu of the current and valid Iowa registration ~~plates~~ plate
20 issued for the vehicle, provided that the current and valid
21 Iowa registration ~~plates~~ plate and the registration card issued
22 for the vehicle are simultaneously carried within the vehicle
23 and are available for inspection to any peace officer upon the
24 officer's request.

25 Sec. _____. Section 321.115A, subsection 1, Code 2025, is
26 amended to read as follows:

27 1. A motor vehicle may be registered as a replica vehicle or
28 street rod. The annual registration fee is the fee provided
29 for in [section 321.109](#), [321.113](#), [321.122](#), or [321.124](#). The
30 owner of a vehicle registered under [this section](#) may display
31 a registration plate or set of plates from or representing
32 the model year of the motor vehicle or the model year of the
33 motor vehicle the registered vehicle is designed to resemble,
34 furnished by the person and approved by the department, in
35 lieu of the current and valid Iowa registration ~~plates~~ plate

1 issued for the vehicle, provided that the current and valid
2 Iowa registration ~~plates~~ plate and the registration card issued
3 for the vehicle are simultaneously carried within the vehicle
4 and are available for inspection to any peace officer upon the
5 officer's request.>

6 3. Page 3, after line 20 by inserting:

7 <Sec. _____. Section 321.385A, subsection 1, paragraph b,
8 Code 2025, is amended to read as follows:

9 b. A citation issued for failure to have rear lamps as
10 required under section 321.387 or a ~~rear~~ registration plate
11 light as required under section 321.388 shall first provide for
12 a seventy-two hour period within which the person charged with
13 the violation shall replace or repair the lamps or light.

14 Sec. _____. Section 321.385A, subsection 2, Code 2025, is
15 amended to read as follows:

16 2. If the person complies with the directive to replace or
17 repair the headlamp, rear lamps, or ~~rear~~ registration plate
18 light within the allotted time period, the citation shall be
19 expunged. If the person fails to comply within the allotted
20 time period, the citation shall be processed in the same manner
21 as other citations.

22 Sec. _____. Section 321.388, Code 2025, is amended to read as
23 follows:

24 **321.388 ~~Illuminating plates~~ Registration plate illuminated.**

25 Either the rear lamp or a separate lamp shall be so
26 constructed and placed as to illuminate with a white light the
27 ~~rear~~ registration plate attached to the rear of the vehicle and
28 render it clearly legible from a distance of fifty feet to the
29 rear. When the ~~rear~~ registration plate is illuminated by an
30 electric lamp other than the required rear lamp, the two lamps
31 shall be turned on or off only by the same control switch at
32 all times when headlamps are lighted. This section does not
33 apply to commercial vehicles engaged exclusively in intrastate
34 commerce that are dump trucks or that are used exclusively for
35 the movement of construction materials and equipment to and

1 from construction projects.

2 Sec. _____. Section 321J.4B, subsection 5, paragraph f,
3 subparagraph (1), Code 2025, is amended to read as follows:

4 (1) If the vehicle subject to the court order is not in
5 the custody of a law enforcement agency, the person or agency
6 designated in the order as the person or agency responsible for
7 executing the order shall, upon receipt of the order, promptly
8 locate the vehicle specified in the order, seize the motor
9 vehicle and the ~~license plates~~ registration plate, and send or
10 deliver the vehicle's ~~license plates~~ registration plate to the
11 department.

12 Sec. _____. Section 321J.4B, subsection 7, Code 2025, is
13 amended to read as follows:

14 7. a. Upon receipt of a notice of conviction of the
15 defendant for a violation of [subsection 2](#), the impounding
16 authority shall seize the motor vehicle's ~~license plates~~
17 registration plate and registration, and shall send or deliver
18 them to the department.

19 b. The department shall destroy ~~license plates~~ a
20 registration plate received under [this section](#) and shall not
21 authorize the release of the vehicle or the issuance of a new
22 ~~license plates~~ registration plate for the vehicle until the
23 period of impoundment or immobilization has expired, and the
24 fee and costs assessed under [subsection 10](#) have been paid. The
25 fee for issuance of a new license plates registration plate and
26 ~~certificates~~ certificate of registration shall be the same as
27 for the replacement of a lost, mutilated, or destroyed license
28 ~~plates~~ registration plate and ~~certificates~~ certificate of
29 registration.

30 Sec. _____. CODE EDITOR DIRECTIVE. The Code editor may make
31 any change the Code editor deems necessary to correct any Code
32 section or any enacted legislation that refers, in any context,
33 to a set of, a pair of, or two motor vehicle registration
34 plates for one vehicle, rather than one registration plate,
35 when there appears to be no doubt as to the proper method of

1 making the correction.

2 Sec. _____. TRANSITION PROVISIONS. The transition from the
3 use of motor vehicle registration plates on both the front
4 and rear of certain vehicles to the use of such plates on
5 only the rear of certain vehicles, as directed by this Act,
6 shall be accomplished in stages. A person applying for a new
7 or replacement registration plate on or after the effective
8 date of this Act shall receive only one registration plate.
9 Otherwise, the transition shall not be accomplished until a new
10 series of registration plates is issued to replace a current
11 series. A person who was issued a pair of registration plates,
12 including special registration plates, may attach only one
13 plate in accordance with this Act on and after the effective
14 date of this Act. A person who is required to transfer a
15 registration plate, or to return a registration plate to the
16 department of transportation or to a county treasurer, shall
17 transfer or return both plates, as applicable, if the person
18 was issued a pair of plates. The department of transportation
19 may adopt rules pursuant to chapter 17A to implement the
20 transition.>

21 4. Title page, line 1, after <including> by inserting <the
22 issuance and display of one registration plate,>

23 5. Title page, line 2, by striking <frames> and inserting
24 <frames,>

25 6. By renumbering as necessary.

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